

War is a terrible thing but it is also disturbingly fascinating to the human race in general. Join us as we attempt to breakdown the weapons of war to aid your understanding of the destructive potential at mankind's fingertips

Anirudh Regidi

War. The very word conjures up images of death and destruction, glory and sacrifice, martyrs and madmen. All said and done however, war is simply, as Wikipedia puts it, “an actual, intentional and widespread armed conflict between political communities; a form of political violence.”

There is no honour in war, no glory, you do what you must to survive, to win, that's all there is to it. One might take a moral high ground as to the cause one is fighting for, but in the end, defeating your enemy by any means at your disposal is your goal, and this usually means complete and utter destruction, or doing enough damage that the survivors have no option but to surrender.

To that end, humankind has a mind-boggling arsenal at its disposal, all designed for combat at every conceivable scale. Trillions of dollars have been spent in the development of these weapons of war, not to mention the millions upon millions of lives lost to these very same weapons and the many trillions in property damage. Regardless of this cost, mankind will continue to build these weapons and will continue to fight each other until some significant step in our evolution puts an end to this appetite for destruction.

Mankind's very existence is a constant battle against the odds, a struggle to survive, an incessant one-upmanship that exists, if for nothing else, than to prove a point of view. Some might argue that it's even simpler than that, that humans have an innate desire to “blow stuff up”, that they revel in destruction. There is a kind of queasy joy in seeing something blown to smithereens by the calculated ferocity and disturbingly creative minds of our species.



The visceral power of naval guns in action

Is it a sense of power that drives us? We take as much pleasure in destroying a sand castle as we do in creating it, the more creative the destruction the better. There is a certain sense of catharsis in blowing something up, to feel that shock-wave pass through your chest that shakes

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you to the very core of your being. Admit it, Diwali to you is more about the bombs and rockets than it is about diyas and lights and pujas. You've led a very tame childhood if you haven't tried to blow up an anthill with at least a “bijli bomb” and you're not a geek if you haven't, at one time or the other, sought to recreate a controlled demolition that you've seen on TV. At the same time the festival is also about proving to your arch rivals that you had more fun than them, fun that is defined by the number of bombs you blew up and the quantity of fireworks at your disposal (your arsenal).